

ETIS

Student Cheat Sheet / Quick Reference

Day-to-day guide for evidence, reviews, recommendations, checkpoints, history, and common problems

v0.18.1 candidate manual edition. Local UI validation only; production remains accepted v0.18.0 until protected deployment and human acceptance.

Audience Students using ETIS Engineering Studio

Purpose Give students a compact reference they can keep open while working in Studio.

COMP 330/474 Software Engineering • Fall 2026 • v0.18.1 candidate • October 8, 2026

EXECUTIVE OVERVIEW

Use repository evidence to have a senior-engineer-style conversation, make a defensible decision, and own the consequences. The AI is not the responsible engineer - you are.

1. Normal path

My Team healthy	Inspect evidence	Choose review	Discuss / challenge	State position if ready	Complete / revisit
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2. Which review should I choose?

Review	Choose it when	Best opening move
Board Review	Normal phase-aware developmental review.	Let the board choose the highest-value current challenge.
Focused Review	You have a specific decision, artifact, risk, PR, architecture, or AI-use question.	Name the engineering subject precisely and bring the relevant evidence.
Review Findings	You want to work directly with existing findings.	Select 1-3 related findings; ask, challenge, resolve, accept/defer.

3. How to talk to the reviewer

- Ask questions; do not pretend you understand a challenge you do not understand.
- Say what you know, what you do not know, and what evidence you would seek next.
- Challenge the reviewer with evidence when its interpretation is wrong or incomplete.
- Explain tradeoffs, consequences, constraints, ownership, and change triggers - not only implementation details.
- Use Give me a nudge when stuck; use Build my recommendation only when a consequential decision is actually forming.
- Do not optimize for agreement or polished wording. Engineering meaning matters more than English fluency.

4. Current recommendation

Posture	Meaning
Not ready yet	Keep reasoning; identify missing evidence or authority.
Continue	Proceed on the current path.
Continue with conditions	Proceed only within explicit conditions/guardrails.
Hold / defer	Pause the relevant decision/work until evidence/uncertainty improves.
Reject this path	Recommend a different direction.
Request evidence / escalate	The decision exceeds current evidence or authority.

NOT THE SAME AS COMMITTING

Current recommendation is revisable. Use the later recommendation action only when you are prepared to defend a consequential position.

5. Evidence and findings

Term	Remember
FACT	Frozen repository-derived evidence. The review should not rewrite it.
REVIEW finding	Interpretation of FACT; you may discuss, challenge, resolve, accept/defer, or seek correction.
Strength	Evidence-supported work already defensible.
Equivalent evidence	Different artifact form that serves the intended engineering purpose.
Starter scaffold	Provided structure; not proof that your team performed the work.
Coverage	How much expected/equivalent current-phase evidence is visible - not a course grade.

6. Checkpoints, commits, and old history

- Starting a review automatically freezes the current evidence snapshot - that frozen snapshot is the review checkpoint.
- New commits do not rewrite an active or completed review.
- GitHub is where you inspect exact commit, branch, PR, and tag history.
- Review History is where you revisit earlier engineering conversations against the frozen evidence that existed then.
- Resume an Active session when you want the same conversation/snapshot; start a new review after meaningful new commits when you want a newer snapshot.
- Formal course evidence boundaries (for example a required Git tag) remain separate from developmental Studio checkpoints.

7. A strong engineering answer usually includes

- Your recommendation - or why you are not ready.
- The repository evidence that supports it.
- The important uncertainty or evidence boundary.
- The consequence/residual risk you are accepting.
- Practical conditions, constraints, or guardrails.
- Who owns follow-up.
- What evidence/event would cause you to change, lift, reject, or close the decision.

Current actions and finding closure

Inspect cited source opens the attached frozen artifact. Find supporting evidence searches the frozen snapshot for equivalent evidence; it is bounded and not exhaustive. Discuss helps you understand, Challenge tests an interpretation, and Help me resolve this coaches next work. An absent source must not be replaced by a guessed file link.

Only authoritative corrected or resolved findings are closed. Confirmed, evidence disputed, accepted risk and deferred findings remain open. Inspecting, searching, recommending and completing a review do not close a finding; work after the snapshot cannot close it on that earlier snapshot.

Button-triggered instructions are recorded as review actions, not as words the student wrote. Unsent drafts are preserved and remain private. Optional review context and other concerns stay secondary to the current concern and conversation.

In Help, artifact, challenge and exit dialogs, Tab and Shift+Tab stay within the dialog, Escape dismisses through the existing close action, and focus returns to a usable opener. Escape does not finish a review. Closing a pending challenge does not cancel its submitted request.

8. Fast troubleshooting

Problem	Action
Wrong GitHub account	My Team -> Change linked GitHub account.
Owner/organization authorization required	The personal owner or GitHub organization owner/admin must authorize.
Step 1 done / Step 2 pending	Check & verify repository access.
Finding seems wrong	Challenge it with evidence; use Review Findings for an existing finding.
0% / thin evidence	May mean starter scaffold or missing team-created evidence, not a broken GitHub connection.
Review looks stale after new commits	Expected for a frozen session; start a new review for a newer snapshot.
Active session already exists	Resume it if you want the same frozen-context conversation.
Stuck	Ask a question or use Give me a nudge.
Page repeatedly slow	Retry once; capture browser Network/request information and tell the instructor.

BEST HABIT

Treat the reviewer like a demanding senior engineer: ask questions, bring evidence, admit uncertainty, challenge weak interpretations, and make the decision yours.

TEAM SETUP SHORTCUT

If My Team already shows Verified team repository, do not re-onboard it. Repository trust is team-shared; move on to Engineering Evidence or Studio.

9. Two rooms • multiple Board Reviews • quick reference

Review Room versus Evidence Room

Engineering Review Room = discussion with the Review Board. Engineering Evidence Room = inspection of the latest saved phase evidence. Switch between them without ending a conversation. Confirm snapshot matching before using evidence to discuss an older review.

Selected versus open

Currently viewing means the one review on screen. Several reviews may remain Open. Review History lists earlier sessions; choose Resume for an open one or View for a finished one.

Review changed work

Commit and push your verified work; select Start another Board Review. The previous session retains its snapshot and messages. Same phase + unchanged commit may reuse the same frozen snapshot.

Finish versus accept

Finish this review makes the selected conversation read-only, not deleted. It does not indicate a phase gate passed or an instructor approved your work.

Recover safely

Your unsent reply belongs to its original review and browser tab. On failed start/send, check Review History or conversation before retrying. Help for navigation is available without an AI model call.

Evidence numbers

Evidence-area counters and separate Review Board findings are different categories. Zero area counts do not prove no concerns. An evidence coverage percentage is not a course grade.